

every room. HPNA uses this existing wiring to connect devices to form a LAN. The beauty of this solution is that there is no need for the phone line to be connected or alive: the networking happens using the existing building's wiring. Even if your phone line is alive, this networking solution does not interfere with your standard telephone frequencies, and thus will never interrupt inbound or outbound voice or data calls.



A snap-in wireless card for a PDA

HPNA operates at a frequency much higher than voice or analogue signals, so you always have the use of your phone as is normal. HPNA can connect up to 50 devices, and offers a throughput of 1 Mbps to each device.

The hitch here is that you need to buy HPNA-compatible devices and connectors before you can go about setting up your LAN. Devices can be as much as 1,000 feet apart, and in offices, as much as 10,000 feet apart on different floors of the same building.

HomePlug

Every device in our home needs to be powered. HomePlug does away with excessive wires for everything, as the networking is done using your home's power sockets. This standard can ensure that you always have a broadband connection to the Internet for every device that is connected to a power outlet. HomePlug works by superimposing an analogue data signal onto the standard 50 or 60 Hz AC signals.

The standard is capable of network transmission of 14 Mbps